

Huckleberry Finn

Exercise 1 LANGUAGE: THE USE OF DIALECT

1. In some parts of the novel, Twain has chosen to use a language that deviates from Standard American English and is grammatically incorrect. Look at the first paragraph and rewrite the sentences into Standard American English.
2. Afterwards, answer the questions below.
 - a. What did you change? Consider vocabulary, grammar, and sentence structure.
 - b. Why does Twain choose to use dialect and incorrect grammar?

Exercise 2 ANALYSIS: THE STRUCTURE OF THE NOVEL

1. The novel starts with a “Notice” and an “Explanatory”. What is the author saying here?
2. Why does he find it necessary to state these things?
3. What is the function of the opening?
4. What is the effect on the reader?

Exercise 3 ANALYSIS: THE NARRATOR AND HIS VOICE

1. Who is the narrator of the text? Look at the first 5–6 lines of chapter 1 in particular.
2. The narrator starts off by saying “YOU don’t know...”. Who is the “you”?
3. The narrator also mentions Mark Twain in the opening. What is the effect of this?

Exercise 4 CHARACTERIZATION OF HUCKLEBERRY FINN

What do you know about Huckleberry Finn? Find information in the text and write down the line number(s) where you found the information.

Huckleberry Finn	Information	Line(s)
Facts about Huckleberry.		
How his relationship is to the widow.		
How he feels about staying at the widow's house.		
At the beginning of the novel, Huck talks a great deal about truth. Find these places and discuss why Huck emphasizes this.		
What Huck thinks about the "sivilized" world.		
What freedom is to Huckleberry.		

Exercise 5 STYLE OF WRITING: SOUTHERN LANGUAGE

1. Find examples of Southern language. You can include vocabulary, sentence structure, grammar, dialect, etc. Use the terms presented in the chapter introduction to the South.
2. What effect is achieved by using dialect?